

Core Meaning - Practice Pack

Read each short passage, then answer the questions. The answer key is at the end.

Try this: before choosing an answer, name the skill being tested: explicit meaning, main idea, supporting details, summary, or theme.

Passage 1 - The New Water Station

For years, students at Brookside School filled reusable bottles from two old drinking fountains. The lines were long, especially after physical education classes. In March, the school installed a bottle-filling station near the gym. During the first month, students refilled more than 4,000 bottles there. Teachers also noticed that fewer disposable plastic bottles were left in classroom bins. The school plans to install a second station near the library next year.

1. What did the school install near the gym?

- A. A second library
- B. A bottle-filling station
- C. New classroom bins
- D. A larger gym

2. What is the main idea of the passage?

- A. The gym is the busiest place in the school.
- B. Reusable bottles are expensive to maintain.
- C. A new bottle-filling station made refilling easier and reduced disposable bottle waste.
- D. Teachers want students to drink more water during class.

3. Which detail best supports the idea that students used the new station often?

- A. It was installed in March.
- B. The old fountains had long lines.
- C. Students refilled more than 4,000 bottles during the first month.
- D. The school has a library.

Passage 2 - A Different Meeting Time

The Eastview Neighborhood Council used to meet at 2 p.m. on Saturdays. Attendance stayed low because many residents worked or cared for children during the afternoon. In January, the council moved its monthly meeting to 7 p.m. on Wednesdays and began offering a video call option. Attendance doubled within three months. More residents also submitted ideas before meetings through an online form. The council decided to keep the new schedule for the rest of the year.

4. Which sentence is the best summary of the passage?

- A. The council meets every Wednesday at 7 p.m. and has an online form.
- B. After changing its meeting time and adding online options, the council saw more residents participate and kept the new system.
- C. Many residents work or care for children during the afternoon.
- D. The council had low attendance before January.

5. Which detail best supports the idea that the new system increased participation?

- A. The old meeting was on Saturdays.
- B. The council meets monthly.
- C. Attendance doubled within three months.
- D. The council will use the schedule for the rest of the year.

6. According to the passage, why had attendance been low before the change?

- A. The meetings were too long.
- B. Many residents were busy during the afternoon.
- C. Residents did not know where meetings were held.
- D. The council did not allow new ideas.

Passage 3 - The Borrowed Camera

Mara had promised to return her brother's camera before his weekend trip. On Friday afternoon, she noticed a scratch across the lens cover. She considered putting the camera back in his room without saying anything. Instead, she waited for him in the kitchen and explained that the camera had slipped from her bag. Her brother looked disappointed, but he thanked her for telling him. Together they found a replacement cover online, and Mara offered to pay for it from her savings.

7. What does Mara do after she notices the scratch?

- A. She hides the camera.
- B. She tells her brother what happened.
- C. She buys a new camera immediately.
- D. She leaves for a weekend trip.

8. Which statement best expresses a theme of the passage?

- A. Expensive objects should never be borrowed.
- B. Family members should share everything they own.
- C. Taking responsibility can help repair a problem after a mistake.
- D. Saving money is more important than replacing damaged things.

9. Which detail best supports that theme?

- A. The scratch was on the lens cover.
- B. Mara waited in the kitchen, explained what happened, and offered to pay for a replacement.
- C. Her brother had a weekend trip.
- D. The replacement cover was available online.

Passage 4 - The Night Market Trial

A town wanted more people to visit its small downtown businesses. Instead of immediately closing streets every weekend, officials tested a night market for three Fridays in June. Restaurants stayed open later, local musicians performed, and small vendors used temporary stalls. After the trial, the town surveyed business owners and visitors. Most owners reported higher Friday sales, while visitors said they wanted more seating and clearer parking signs. The town approved another trial for September with extra benches and new signs.

10. What is the main idea of the passage?

- A. The town experimented with a night market, learned from the trial, and planned an improved second trial.
- B. Local musicians should perform every Friday.
- C. Parking is the biggest problem in every downtown area.
- D. Restaurants make more money when streets are closed.

11. Which is the best summary?

- A. A town tested a three-week night market, collected feedback, and approved another trial with changes based on what it learned.
- B. A town held a night market with restaurants, musicians, vendors, benches, signs, surveys, sales, visitors, and parking.
- C. Business owners liked the market because they made more sales.
- D. The town needs clearer parking signs downtown.

12. Which detail directly shows the town used feedback to improve the next trial?

- A. The first trial happened in June.
- B. Restaurants stayed open later.
- C. The next trial would include extra benches and new signs.
- D. Small vendors used temporary stalls.

Answer key

Check the reason, not only the letter.

#	Answer	Skill	Why
1	B	Explicit meaning	The passage directly says the school installed a bottle-filling station near the gym.
2	C	Main idea	It covers the whole passage: easier refilling, heavy use, and less disposable bottle waste.
3	C	Supporting details	4,000+ refills is direct evidence that students used the station often.
4	B	Summary	It keeps the problem, the change, the result, and the decision without unnecessary detail.
5	C	Supporting details	Attendance doubling is direct evidence of increased participation.
6	B	Explicit meaning	The passage states that residents were working or caring for children in the afternoon.
7	B	Explicit meaning	Mara waits and tells her brother what happened.
8	C	Theme	The story shows that honesty and responsibility help address a mistake.
9	B	Supporting details	That action directly shows Mara taking responsibility.
10	A	Main idea	It covers the trial, the feedback, and the improved follow-up plan.
11	A	Summary	It includes the essential sequence without listing every feature of the market.
12	C	Supporting details	The benches and signs directly respond to visitor feedback about seating and parking signs.

Original passages and questions by Studo. Skill alignment informed by the GED Testing Service RLA Assessment Guide for Educators.